
HUNTBRIEF FIELD STUDY

DRURY BROTHERS

DEER HUNTING METHODOLOGY

Mindset · 13 Phases · Food Architecture · Wind · Access · Target Bucks

A detailed compilation of how Missouri brothers Mark and Terry Drury think about mature whitetails — the thirteen biological phases of the season, kill-plot architecture, hidden access, cold-front timing, the 75/25 wind rule, and why they would rather hunt October and December than peak November for a specific giant.

THE SIX-STEP OPERATING SYSTEM

1. Shorten the walk — a mature buck that can fill up next to his bed will do it in daylight.
2. Design access first. If you blow the bedroom walking in, the stand does not exist.
3. Hunt wind-specific trees. A northwest tree is hunted only on a northwest wind.
4. Hunt the phase, not the cliché. October and December beat peak November for a named buck.
5. Stack a front, falling temperature, rising barometer, and a 7–10 mph face-wind before you go.
6. Do no harm. If any piece is wrong — stay home. Intrusion is the silent killer of old bucks.

Prepared for Casey Summerlin · Anson County, North Carolina
September 9, 2026

*Drawn from Drury Outdoors shows, DeerCast, interviews, and published articles through 2026.
Not a reprint of THIRTEEN and not a substitute for their app, videos, or paid products.*

Contents

1. Who the Drury Brothers Are — and Why Their System Matters
2. The Core Mindset
3. The Thirteen Phases of Deer Season
4. Farm Design and Food-Plot Architecture
5. Routes, Paths, and Access
6. Wind, Thermals, and the 75/25 Rule
7. Weather, Fronts, Barometer, and DeerCast
8. Hunting a Specific Buck
9. Cameras, Scouting, and Summer Inventory
10. Calling, Decoys, and Rut Body Language
11. The 365-Day Work Calendar
12. Discipline — When They Stay Home
13. The Six-Step Operating System
14. Applying This Thinking on the Anson County Farm
15. Drury vs. Herndon vs. Higgins
16. Sources and How to Go Deeper

This document is a field study, not a reprint of THIRTEEN and not a how-to for illegal activity. Tactics are compiled from material Mark and Terry Drury have published or spoken about publicly through 2026. Phase dates are Midwest-centered and slide with latitude, gun seasons, and the year.

1. Who the Drury Brothers Are — and Why Their System Matters

Mark and Terry Drury are Missouri brothers who co-founded Drury Outdoors in 1989. They grew up in the Bloomsdale / Ste. Genevieve County country south of St. Louis, with hardwood timber running from the back door toward the Mississippi River. Their father Ralph ran a construction business. Hunting was more a community and brother-driven craft than a family television plan. Terry, the older brother by about ten years, is a civil engineer who built T. Drury Contracting. Mark was the competitive caller — more than 150 wins on the turkey circuit and six World Championship titles — who left the family trade in 1989, split the cost of a Panasonic AG-450 camera with Terry, and started putting hunts on VHS.

The first tapes were turkey videos (*King of the Spring, Sound of the Spring*). A 1992 bowhunting tape with seven successful deer harvests pulled them into the whitetail market. In 1994 they launched M.A.D. Calls. In 1998 Mark killed a 195 2/8-inch Illinois buck that was widely called the largest wild whitetail captured on film at the time. That footage changed the company's trajectory. Television followed: *Wildlife Obsession, Dream Season, Bow Madness, THIRTEEN, Deer Season*, and a weekly podcast. In 2018 they released DeerCast, an app that turns their phase-and-weather logic into an hourly daylight-movement forecast.

Family is the operating unit. Mark's wife Tracy and daughter Taylor, Terry's wife Willa and son Matt, and an extended "DOD team" appear on camera and in the woods. Both brothers were inducted into the Legends of the Outdoors Hall of Fame in 2016 and the Missouri Sports Hall of Fame in 2019. Mark later entered the NWTFF Grand National Calling Championships Hall of Fame. The ethic they will not drop is printed on everything they ship: **100% Wild, 100% Fair Chase.**

They matter to a farm hunter not because they invented terrain reading — they did not — but because they built the most widely watched operating system for *when* a mature farmland buck is killable, *how* to build food and access so he moves in daylight, and *which sits to refuse*. Mark is the "Mad Scientist": 365-day land manager, camera accountant, front hunter.

Terry is “Old Man Winter”: access, ethics, structure, and the refusal to hunt a dirty setup on film.

2. The Core Mindset

The Drury system starts with a sentence Mark has repeated for years: a farm-country buck is the same animal as a buck in the South, Texas, or out West. What changes is the matrix around him — crops, cattle, people, predators, and how far he must walk to fill his belly. Until breeding hijacks him, life is feed-to-bed and bed-to-feed. Stomach first. Security second. Rut third.

What that mindset produces in practice

- **Shorten the walk and you almost win.** A mature buck that can feed 50–150 yards from his bed will do it in daylight. A 400-yard open-field crossing waits for dark.
- **Hunter intrusion is the silent killer.** Terry’s line: the number-one reason most people never grow old bucks is they walk the bedroom too often. Sanctuary plus hidden access is rule one through five.
- **Hunt the buck, not the November cliché.** Mark would rather hunt October and December than peak November if the goal is a *specific* mature deer. November turns expectation into hope.
- **Stack conditions. Don’t guess.** One factor is never enough. Front + temperature crash + face-wind + rising barometer + the right phase is a hunt. Anything less is a walk.
- **Minimize mistakes, don’t maximize sits.** “You don’t learn until you make a few mistakes. The guys who minimize those mistakes kill the most mature deer on a consistent basis.”
- **Do no harm in the first three phases.** Early season is where most hunters blow the farm for November.
- **Mother Nature is the star.** Drought, EHD, leaf-drop, gun pressure, and a warm December rewrite the plan. They change tactics. They do not argue with the year.
- **Fair chase is a constraint, not a slogan.** Terry will not film or hunt a situation that violates the ethic. That constraint shapes stand choice as much as the wind does.

THE SENTENCE THAT RUNS THE WHOLE SYSTEM

A mature buck is a slave to his stomach until breeding hijacks him — and even then, food and wind still run the show. Design the farm so he can feed, bed, and travel in daylight without bumping you. Then only hunt him when weather, wind, food, and the calendar agree.

3. The Thirteen Phases of Deer Season

THIRTEEN is not a TV gimmick. It is how Mark and Terry divided the fall after decades of daily notes. They argue that “pre-rut / rut / post-rut” is too coarse. A whitetail’s personality, food, daylight window, and home-range size change about thirteen times between mid-September and mid-January. Hunt the personality of the phase. Dates below are Midwest-centered (roughly the latitude of northern Missouri / southern Iowa) and slide a little with latitude, firearm seasons, and the year. Use them as a skeleton, not a law.

Phase	Typical window	What the buck is doing	How they hunt it
1 — New Beginning	Sept 13–25	Summer pattern. Bed almost on food. Little daylight walking. Heat and thermals dominate.	Evenings only. Hunt does and fringe ground. Do not hunt known mature-buck bedrooms at daylight. Wait for a front.
2 — Greener Pastures	Sept 25–Oct 12	Green food still draws. Daylight ticks up if weather helps. Beans and clover are the grocery.	Stay on green. Cameras decide which plots are “on.” Still mostly evenings.

Phase	Typical window	What the buck is doing	How they hunt it
3 — October Lull	Oct 13–25	~95% night movement. Scrapes appear — almost all after dark. Necks still look like summer.	Do less harm than good. Observe. Do not burn best trees. Skip target-buck mornings.
4 — Pre-Lock	Oct 25–Nov 1	Favorite kill window. Necks swell, scrapes explode, range expands, first-doe hunt. Giants on their feet.	Kill plots become meeting grounds. Calling works. Sit the 50-yard line. Many of their biggest film bucks die here.
5 — High Excitement	Nov 2–5	Seeking hard. Core areas stretch. Posture changes: ears back, hair up, traveling with purpose.	Read body language before you call. Visibility stands. Don't get greedy on 3-year-olds.
6 — Buck Parade	early Nov	Young and satellite bucks everywhere. Mature ones still looking before they lock.	See a long way. Pass the parade if you are hunting a 6–8 year old.
7 — Lockdown	mid-Nov	Mature bucks vanish with the first hot doe. Young bucks still cruise.	Don't panic. Funnels between doe bedding. All-day sits more justified.
8 — Desperately Seeking	late mid-rut	Second wave. Bucks back on their feet hunting leftovers.	Cruising terrain, saddles, creek crossings, doe-bedding edges.
9 — The Party's Over	late Nov	Primary breeding fading. Calories start to matter again.	Do not abandon plots. Transition back toward food.
10 — Green Revisited	Nov 26–Dec 5	Mature bucks return to green fields for does and calories. Green palatability spikes.	Big afternoon sits on clover / remaining green. Another high-odds giant window.
11 — Waiting on a Front	Dec 6–8	Mini-lull. Need weather to flip the switch.	Stay ready. A front turns this phase on overnight.
12 — Feedback	Dec 9–21	Best late-season movement. Food is everything. Bucks can lose 20%+ of body weight in the rut.	Get in early afternoon. Grain if brutal cold; green if warm. Cameras on food and transitions.
13 — Grand Finale	Dec 22–Jan 15	Yarding into thermal cover next to last food. Daylight dies unless a savage front hits.	Hunt warmest cover + last calories. Small windows only. Do not overhunt empty plots.

Mark's October nuance, stated often: two hot pockets — roughly **October 5–12** and **October 25–31** (especially the 27th–31st). The middle of October is the lull he skips for a named buck. November is still excellent if you want a good deer moving. It is a poorer month for patterning one specific 6½- to 8½-year-old and sitting him on a food line.

PHASE 1 RULE THEY WILL NOT BEND

If cameras are not showing a mature buck moving in daylight, a daylight sit on his bedroom does more harm than good. Just before daylight is when older bucks often move. Spook him then and you have educated the one deer you wanted. Hunt the fringe. Hunt the evening. Wait for the first real cool front before you sit his tree at dawn.

4. Farm Design and Food-Plot Architecture

This is where “Mad Scientist” stops being a nickname. Mark starts the farm in March, not September. Habitat grows the herd. Layout kills the shooter. He will take a cattle pasture with water and no cover and spend a year adding grass, hinge-cuts, plots, roads, and blinds before he treats it as a hunting property.

Food architecture

- **Destination fields** — soybeans, standing grain — for late-season nutrition and herd holding power.

- **Kill plots ≈ one acre** (a football field). Small enough to shoot across. He wants to sit the 50-yard line with the wind in his face. Large destination fields are hard to hunt; small plots concentrate the shot.
- **Variety by phase.** Palatability changes all fall. Clover is the plant he says “wins the day most often,” even in drought. Radishes and winter brassicas near the blind; grain or beans farther out.
- **Rough food target on new ground:** about 3 percent of the farm in food — enough to hold deer, not so much that they smear out.
- **Soil first.** Test, lime, hit pH. Palatability is the point, not merely a green color on an aerial.

Cover, bedding, and water

- Timber-stand improvement in March–April to dump light on the forest floor and grow native browse.
- East- and south-facing slopes for morning-sun beds. They have watched their deer prefer those aspects.
- Summer hinge-cuts 150–200 yards off a plot so a buck can bed, stand up, and be in the plot in daylight.
- Warm-season grass and CRP-style cover on old cattle pasture. If cover is missing, food and water will not save the farm.
- Small water holes in dry timber are “lethal” in the rut. A cruising buck hits them all day. They pre-scout new holes with cameras a year before they hang a blind.

Wind-specific trees, not “a good spot”

A northwest-wind tree is hunted on a northwest wind. South wind? Different tree or stay home. They will hunt the same tree every time that wind and the forecast agree — and never when they do not. Box blinds (Muddy and similar) have become more common as they age and hunt with kids: contain scent, sit longer, cover more winds. Tree stands stay in the rotation when the tree and the wind are perfect.

MARK ON KILL PLOTS

“When you can reduce how far a deer must travel to fill his belly, you’ve almost won the game, in my opinion. That’s why a lot of our fields are the size of football fields. For killing deer, we’ve discovered that’s the optimum size for a food plot many times. I love sitting on the 50-yard line of a kill plot with the wind in my face.”

5. Routes, Paths, and Access

Ask Terry what he looks at first on a new tract and he will not start with a scrape. He starts with structure and a clean walk. Access is “mega key.” You do not walk through deer to reach the plot you intend to hunt. Roads, gates, and hiking trails are designed so entry dumps scent into open ag, a pond, a deep ravine, or a creek draw — never into the pine thicket or creek bedding the shooter uses at daylight.

How they build a route

- Multiple entries for multiple winds. One pretty trail that only works on a west wind is a half-farm.
- Screen the walk. Use terrain, ditch, fencerow, standing crop, or planted screens so deer in the plot cannot watch you arrive.
- Keep the exit as clean as the entry. A blown exit educates the herd for the next sit.
- Do not cut a trail through the bedroom to “get closer.” Closer with dirty access is farther from a mature buck.
- On new farms they budget gates, cleaned fence, and fixed roads before they hang the first stand. Logistics is hunting.
- Cameras go on gate gaps and water holes a year early — not to hunt last night’s photo, but to decide whether a future plot or blind belongs there.

Morning versus evening topography is part of the route, not a separate subject. Mark's general rule: in the morning he likes to be high on the ridge or spine — rising thermals, a long view, scent lifting off the walk. In the evening he will sit lower toward food only if the wind is strong enough to override the evening thermal dump. Weak evening wind in a hole is a sit he refuses.

6. Wind, Thermals, and the 75/25 Rule

A deer's primary tool is its nose. Mark's entire stand map is a wind map. Thermals in Phase 1 and 2 are as dangerous as a swirling October ditch. Sweating into a still September evening is how you educate a whole farm before the first cold front ever arrives.

During the rut he uses a rule he has stated on *Wired to Hunt*: if he can fool **75 percent of the noses** and get caught by about 25 percent, he is close enough to the terrain to kill a giant. Getting busted by a **doe** is worse than getting busted by a buck. Doe panic dominoes the field — especially in December, when one blow-up can shut a plot down. During the rut a spooked deer can be replaced in ten minutes because bucks are covering ground. That is why he accepts more scent risk in November than he will accept in December.

Practical wind rules they live by

- Hunt with the wind in your face whenever the farm allows it.
- Use terrain to throw scent into dead space: water, ditches, open soybeans, a deep ravine.
- Do not hunt swirling holes just because a camera lit up there. They learned this the hard way in bottoms, then switched to enclosed blinds or abandoned the sit.
- A 7–10 mph steady wind is the sweet spot they cite when stacking a “best day.”
- If the stand faces northwest, hunt it on northwest. Do not “make it work” on southwest.
- Early-season thermals: assume evening air will fall downhill. Sit where falling air does not pour your scent into the plot or the bed.

RUT WIND MATH

“I always felt like during the rut if I could fool 75% of the noses and get caught by about 25% I was pretty close to where I need to be within the terrain to take advantage of and kill a big buck. ... It is far more detrimental to your overall hunt right now to get caught by a doe. Doe dominoes everything back.” — Mark Drury

7. Weather, Fronts, Barometer, and DeerCast

Mark is a front hunter. Circle the dates when the bottom falls out of the temperature and the wind turns north or northwest. “Don’t miss any cold fronts.” At the end of the fall you can almost mark those days as the ones when the biggest bucks get killed. How good a particular front is still depends on the phase — a November front during lockdown is not the same animal as an October 28 front during pre-lock — but the front is the switch.

The stacked “best day” they look for

- Three or four days before or after a full moon (a factor they still watch, not a religion).
- Temperature about 10 degrees below average for that location.
- A little spit of rain — not a soaker, not a bluebird high-sun day.
- A 7–10 mph wind in your face.
- Rising barometer in the 30.15 to 30.5 range.

- The first day after a front, when the wind swings back south and temperature bumps, can also be magic.

Late season they switch food with the thermometer, not the date. Brutal post-rut cold sends bucks and does to large agricultural grain. A warm snap sends them back to green. A buck can lose more than 20 percent of his body weight during the rut. He will eat. The only question is which grocery he chooses that afternoon.

DeerCast (2018) is this logic turned into software: the thirteen phases plus local weather plus historical daylight movement, delivered hour by hour. They have said roughly thirteen influencers decide whether a whitetail is on his feet in daylight. The app is the public form of the notebook they kept for 25 years. It does not replace a wind-correct tree. It tells you whether today is a day to walk to that tree.

8. Hunting a Specific Buck

This is the part that looks like television and is actually homework. They do not “go hunting.” They decide in summer which bucks are early-season targets and which get another year, then they build one clean walk to a wind-correct tree that intersects that buck’s bed-to-food line.

The target-buck loop

- **July cameras on green fields.** Separate the plots bucks use from the plots does use.
- **Inventory personality, not just inches.** First ten days after a summer full moon, more mature bucks hit green fields in the afternoon. Watch temperament.
- **Age class decision now.** They like harvesting 6½- to 8½-year-olds — body and antler peak, and those deer start choosing food and security over chasing the whole county.
- **Assign a wind and a tree.** One stand, one wind, one phase. Do not hunt that tree until the forecast and the phase say he will daylight.
- **History over last night’s photo.** They review prior-year pictures farm by farm: which spots turn on after leaf-drop, which farms are early-season only, which become late-season highways when cover opens.
- **Satellite farms.** Several 50–150 acre places beat one giant property you hammer. More first-sits. Less education.
- **Leaf-off is a hard switch.** Home ranges and visibility change overnight in mid- to late October. A farm that was empty in September can become a draw-to-draw highway in December.

When they get on a named buck they will hunt him every time the assigned wind and the stacked forecast agree. They will not hunt him on the wrong wind “because I only have Saturday.” That Saturday on the wrong wind is how a 5½-year-old becomes a neighbor’s 6½-year-old.

9. Cameras, Scouting, and Summer Inventory

Cameras are a census and a calendar, not a permission slip. Mark starts hunting a buck in July when antlers are just beginning to develop. He wants to know which green fields bucks use and which green fields does prefer. Motion cameras go on the trails into those fields. He also wants to see the animal with his own eyes — from a distance that does not bump him.

- Summer glassing and cameras tell you who lives on you. Fall cameras tell you when he daylights.
- Move cameras with the phase. Early: green fields and trails. Rut: funnels, water, doe bedding edges. Late: food and the transitions into food.
- A camera on a new water hole or fence gap is often a one-year pre-scout for a future blind, not a sit this October.
- No daylight photos of the shooter does not mean “go sit his bed at dawn.” It means stay out.
- After the season they go back through every card and reconstruct which spots were best in which phase. That file becomes next year’s map.

10. Calling, Decoys, and Rut Body Language

Calling is a Phase 4–6 tool, not a season-long habit. Pre-lock is when they “knock the ball out of the park” with calling because mature bucks are hunting the first estrous doe and will respond to a fight or a hot doe they have not found yet. Lockdown calling at a buck already tending is a different, poorer bet.

Mark’s seeking-phase filter: watch the walk. A buck traveling with intent, unaware of his surroundings, ears laid back, hair up — call him. A slow browser is not a caller’s deer. Leave him. During seeking they also choose stands with a long view, because bucks start using their eyes and will cut open ground looking for does.

They will rattle from a high spot where sound carries and where scent passes over a circling buck. They have also spent decades learning that brother-to-brother hand signals in adjacent trees are a good way to almost kill a 190-inch deer and each other. The lesson under the joke: two people in the same funnel need one plan.

11. The 365-Day Work Calendar

Season	What they are doing
Right after season	Winter feed if you use it. Rest the ground. Reconstruct the camera year. Decide which bucks get another year.
March–April	Timber-stand improvement. Spring plantings. Clover. Soil work. Lime. This is when next fall is won.
Early summer	Mow and spray clover. Keep plots palatable. Water-hole checks from the edge.
Mid-summer	Hinge-cut bedding 150–200 yards off plots while foliage hides the work. Set summer cameras on greens.
July–August	Inventory bucks. Assign early-season vs. let-him-go. Match each shooter to a wind, a tree, and a phase. Fix access.
September (Phase 1–2)	Evenings. Fringe. Doe management if the ratio demands it. Do not burn the bedroom.
October 5–12 / 25–31	Primary target-buck windows before lockdown. Kill plots. Fronts. Calling as pre-lock arrives.
November	Hunt seeking and the edges of lockdown. Accept 75/25 wind math. Don’t abandon food entirely.
Late Nov–December	Green Revisited, then Feedback. Food is the stand. Switch grain vs. green with the thermometer.
Year-round	Keep sanctuaries unwalked. Hunt the fringe first. Access is a living thing — grow it over, don’t wear it in.

12. Discipline — When They Stay Home

The unglamorous half of the system is the sit they do not take. Wrong wind. Swirling ditch. Phase 3 lull on a target-buck tree. A Saturday that only works if you pretend southwest is northwest. A morning walk that blows a daylight bed. They have said out loud that early-season anticipation is the enemy — you want to hunt because the season just opened, and that is exactly when a mature buck is most patternable and most educable.

- If cameras show no daylight, do not invent a morning sit to “make something happen.”
- If you will sweat a quart into a 78-degree evening, you are not hunting. You are broadcasting.
- If the only access walks the plot edge the deer use, the stand is closed until you build another walk.
- If it is mid-October lull and you have a pre-lock tree saved, save it.
- If December is warm and you only have a bean-field stand, go to green or stay home.
- If a doe will stand in your scent stream and blow, especially late season, pick another tree.

13. The Six-Step Operating System

Compressed to something you can run on a farm you did not grow up on:

#	Step	What it means on the ground
1	Shorten the walk	Build or plant food so a mature buck can fill up next to cover. Kill plots ~1 acre. Destination grain for late season.
2	Access first	One clean walk per wind. Dump scent into open or dead space. Never through the bedroom.
3	Wind-specific trees	A northwest tree is a northwest hunt. Morning high, evening lower only if wind beats thermals.
4	Hunt the phase	13 personalities, not 3. October 5–12 and 25–31, plus Green Revisited / Feedback, beat peak November for a named buck.
5	Stack the day	Front, temp ~10° below average, 7–10 mph face-wind, rising barometer, spit of rain. DeerCast as the hourly check.
6	Do no harm	If any piece is wrong, stay home. Intrusion is how old bucks become someone else's deer.

14. Applying This Thinking on the Anson County Farm

The locked HuntBrief property — 308.44 acres in Anson County, North Carolina (35.076243, -80.193882), Central Deer Zone — already speaks Drury's language. Large ag fields are soybeans in 2026. Blue circles are fall food plots. Orange pins are the thirteen named stands. Creek bottoms and pine thickets are the security cover. Drury does not replace the locked Herndon terrain engine (saddles, benches, points, inside corners, creek funnels). He tells you *when* those funnels are worth sitting and *how* to treat the beans and plots so a buck uses them in daylight.

Translation, stand-system level

- Treat the soybean fields as the late-season / destination grocery store (Phase 12–13, and any brutal cold snap).
- Treat the fall food plots as kill plots — hunt them like one-acre football fields, not like mini-ag fields. Sit the edge with wind in your face.
- Build or only use access that dumps scent into open beans or a creek draw, never into Pine Thicket, GaGa Woods, or the creek bedding.
- Right now (September 9, 2026) you are in Phase 1. Evenings. Fringe stands. Do not walk daylight beds. Wait for the first real cool front before a dawn sit on a mature-buck tree.
- Highest-odds target-buck windows on this farm, if NC weather cooperates: last week of October into November 1 (pre-lock), then late November through mid-December (Green Revisited + Feedback). Shift a few days later than Missouri if your herd is on a southern clock.
- A north or northwest front after a hot spell is the day you cancel everything else — that is Mark's circled date.
- Legal frame: NC Central Zone archery runs September 12 – October 30, 2026; blackpowder October 31 – November 13; gun November 14 – January 1, 2027. Shooting hours are 30 minutes before sunrise to 30 minutes after sunset. Bag is 6 deer (2 antlered, 4 antlerless). Phase 1 doe work is legal here if the farm's buck-to-doe ratio needs it.
- Named stands that sit on plot or field edges with a clean field-side walk are the Drury primary set. Interior woods stands are Herndon funnel sits for seeking / lockdown, not Phase 1–3 food sits.

ANSON COUNTY, THIS WEEK

Phase 1. Soybeans still standing. Fall plots coming on. Heat and thermals are the enemy. Hunt evenings on the fringe. Let the creek bottoms and pine thickets stay unwalked. The first stacked cool front is the first time a dawn sit on a named mature-buck tree is worth the intrusion.

15. Drury vs. Herndon vs. Higgins

HuntBrief already carries two other field studies. They do not cancel each other. They answer different questions.

Question they answer	Drury	Herndon (locked engine)	Higgins
Starting point	Food + phase + weather	The map: choke points that never move	Sanctuary + zero intrusion
What they design first	Kill plots, access roads, wind trees	Saddles, benches, points, inside corners, creek funnels	A bedroom the buck never shares with a human
When they sit	Stacked front inside the right phase	Any legal day the wind lets you hunt that choke	Same time / same place / same temperature history
October vs November	October and December preferred for a named buck	Terrain works all year; wind is the filter	Weather can override the rut; stay home if it's wrong
Shot they want	50-yard line of a 1-acre plot, or a funnel during seeking	The easiest concealed daylight path through terrain	15–20 yards on the sanctuary edge
Best use on Anson ground	When to sit the plots and beans; how to walk them	Which stand the wind and terrain pick today	Which acres stay unwalked all year

A clean stack on this farm: Herndon picks the choke point. Higgins decides whether that choke is on the edge of a sanctuary or inside a bedroom you should never enter. Drury decides whether today — this phase, this front, this food — is a day that choke is worth the walk.

16. Sources and How to Go Deeper

This field study is compiled from material Mark and Terry Drury have put in public: DruryOutdoors.com history and team pages; the *THIRTEEN* phase rundowns and podcast breakdowns; North American Whitetail's "Drury Brothers' Keys to Hunting Farmland"; Mossy Oak interviews on phases, 365-day management, and preseason prep; Field & Stream and Wired to Hunt conversations on late season, wind, and the 75/25 rule; Deer Season episodes on food-plot architecture and new-farm builds; and the public description of DeerCast. Dates and phase names follow their Midwest skeleton and will not match every county in North Carolina on the same calendar day.

Go deeper in their own words

- Drury Outdoors — druryoutdoors.com (history, team, streaming hunts).
- THIRTEEN phase rundown playlist on the DruryOutdoors YouTube channel (Phases 1–13, two minutes each).
- DeerCast app — hourly daylight forecast built on the same thirteen phases.
- 100% Wild podcast — weekly, including the wind master-class with Mark.
- North American Whitetail, "The Drury Brothers' Keys to Hunting Farmland" (Lynn Burkhead).
- Mossy Oak features: Terry on the thirteen phases; Mark on 365-day management; preseason camera-to-stand workflow.

How HuntBrief should use this layer

- Keep Herndon as the terrain picker — saddles, benches, points, inside corners, creek and fencerow funnels.
- Use Drury to rate the *day*: phase, front, temperature crash, face-wind, rising barometer, food that is palatable *this week*.
- Use Higgins to protect the bedroom. If the Herndon funnel sits inside a sanctuary, it is not a Phase 1 sit.
- On a briefing morning: name the phase, say whether the stacked front is in, pick the wind-correct plot-edge or funnel stand, and write the walk that dumps scent into beans or a creek — not into Pine Thicket or GaGa Woods.
- Default Phase 1–3 recommendation is evening, fringe, do-no-harm. Default pre-lock and Feedback recommendation is the kill-plot 50-yard line on the correct wind.

Nothing here is a license to trespass, bait where illegal, or ignore North Carolina Wildlife Resources Commission rules. HuntBrief's daily briefing remains the operational document for wind, legal hours, and stand picks on the Anson County farm. This study is the Drury layer underneath those picks.

FIELD-STUDY LIMIT

This is a compilation of public methodology, not a consulting visit from Mark or Terry Drury and not an official Drury Outdoors product. Phase windows will move. Farms differ. The six steps do not.